



The snow flies as Rob McDougall and Chris Munro slide down the hill at Gemmill Park Thursday.

Man taken to Arnprior hospital after snowmobile overturns on lake

A southwestern, Ont., man was taken to Arnprior hospital with major injuries after he was thrown from his snowmobile while riding on White Lake New Year's Day.

Police report John Doogan, 63, of Drumbo, Ont., was southbound on the surface at 2:45 p.m. when he lost control of his 1996 Polaris. The snow vehicle rolled several times and the driver was ejected.

The snowmobile had minor damage although Doogan had to be taken to hospital by ambulance.

Police report the operator was wearing a helmet.

"It may well be that fact that saved his life," said Const. Neil Fennell, Community Services Officer with the OPP's Perth detachment.

No charges were laid.

Const. Al Gainforth investigated.

Man guilty of snatching purse

A 21-year-old Almonte man was found guilty of taking a purse from an elderly woman Oct. 10, 1995.

David Dugdale's trial was adjourned in Smiths Falls court Monday for sentencing. Because a pre-sentence report was requested, it could take at least four to six weeks.

Dugdale, who lives at 359 Ottawa St. in Almonte, took the purse around 1 p.m. Oct. 10 as a woman walked down Wilkinson Street. He then ran onto Union Street.

Woman gets suspended sentence

Candice Lee received a suspended sentence and one year's probation for her part in a fight outside Dave and Garry's All-Star Saloon Nov. 23. Lee, 25, of 3-334 Maude St. in Almonte, pleaded guilty in Smiths Falls

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court Monday to the charge of assault causing bodily harm. Two men got into a fight and went outside the bar Nov. 23 when Almonte OPP Const. Greg Danschinko and Wayne Rockburne came to break it up.

A 29-year-old woman told one of those involved in the altercation to walk away, and was punched in the mouth by Lee.

Along with her suspended sentence and probation, Lee must pay \$102 in restitution.

Woman loses licence for year

An Almonte woman lost her licence for a year after pleading guilty to driving with more than the legal limit of alcohol in her blood.

Marie Mitchell, 31, of 94 Mill St., was stopped in a RIDE team spotcheck on Almonte's main street Dec. 15. She automatically lost her licence for three months that evening.

She pleaded guilty Dec. 23 in Smiths Falls court. Judge Inger Hansen also fined Mitchell \$300.

An impaired driving charge was withdrawn.

Woman fined for narcotics possession

Judge Inger Hansen fined a Hoptown woman \$200 in Smiths Falls court Dec. 23 for possession of marijuana.

Donna Echlin, 43, was charged in mid-September when OPP Const. Randy Cota noticed marijuana plants growing in Lanark Township.

A search warrant turned up seeds and live and dried plants.

Echlin was also put on probation for two years. A cultivation charge was withdrawn.

Charges are expected to be dropped against a 17-year-old youth also charged after the raid.

Charges dropped in cow killing

A Lanark man has been cleared of all criminal charges related to two cows' deaths in Dalhousie Township in June.

Crown attorney John Waugh withdrew charges of theft of cattle, endangering cattle and two firearm offences against Chris Drew, 27.

Terence James, 31, was convicted Nov. 25 of shooting the two cows and stealing the hindquarters of one. He received a two-year suspended sentence and was ordered to repay the farmer for lost income.

George Young, 42, is scheduled to appear in Smiths Falls court Jan. 27 to face his charges from the incident.

RIDE results in charge

RIDE spotchecks (Reduce Impaired Driving Everywhere) in town New Year's Eve resulted in one driver being charged with having more than 80 mg. of alcohol per 100 ml. of blood in their system.

Paul Hurl, 39, of Five Arches Drive in Pakenham was stopped at Highway 15 and Almonte Street at approximately 8:35 p.m. He appears in Smiths Falls court Jan. 13.

Almonte OPP Sgt. Dale McIlmoyl said 180 vehicles were stopped at various points in town between 8 p.m. and 2 a.m. One liquor seizure and one 12-hour licence suspension was issued.

"It was off and on all evening," he said.

School board briefs

Trustees with the Lanark County Board of Education discussed these issues and others at the Dec. 17 board meeting. Beckwith Trustee Lynda Foster was absent.

Laughlin says goodbye

John Laughlin headed his last board meeting as director of education, thanking many people for the support he had received during his three years in Lanark.

Laughlin listed trustees, staff and teachers among his supporters, pointing out those who had particularly helped him. He officially began at the Lanark Board of Education yesterday (Jan. 1). Gino Giannandrea comes from the Huron County Board of Education to take Laughlin's position.

Laughlin gave his final Lanark annual report at the meeting, pointing out the highlights of the past year. In a joint message, Laughlin and Chair June Timmons talked about the difficulties of planning the 1996 budget, school improvement plans, the new Arklan school in Carleton Place, and partnerships.

The annual report details committee happenings, partnerships, the mission statement and the board's beliefs.

Committee structure questioned

Carleton Place Trustee Craig Rogers wants to revamp the board's committee structure.

Rogers gave the board a notice of motion, saying he wanted the chair to establish a committee to review the structure before the February meeting.

"I'd like to see the full board in this," Carleton Place Trustee Ted Letts added. "I believe the committee structure we now have in the board has outlived its usefulness."

Smiths Falls Trustee Gerry Huddleston agreed. "It looks to the media like we're just rubber-stamping things (at the board meetings)," Huddleston said. "We've all admitted action takes place in the first, second and third committee meeting of the month."

Regular board meetings fall on the fourth Tuesday of every month.

Chair June Timmons cautioned Huddleston, saying, "Committee meetings are all open meetings."

In the end, trustees decided to have a committee of the whole board the third Tuesday of January to discuss the committee structure.

Snobelen misunderstands

Ontario Minister of Education and Training John Snobelen missed the point of a letter from the school board recently.

Snobelen sent a letter to director of education John Laughlin in early December, thanking the board for supporting the government's efforts to reform the education system in Ontario.

"Thank you again for your kind words of support," Snobelen concluded.

In reality, the board supported a resolution by the Carleton Roman Catholic Separate School Board, asking the minister to stop making negative comments about education in Ontario. The resolution also states that Snobelen should recognize the impact on students of further funding reduction to education and acknowledge the value of locally elected school boards as advocates and representatives of local communities.

Members sign petition

School board trustees got a chance to sign a petition asking the provincial government to protect education and classroom funding.

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Pakenham briefs

By Maureen Macartney-Grierson
The following issues were discussed by Pakenham township Dec. 17.

Action plan to secure Pakenham tax arrears

As of Dec. 17, the township is owed \$179,523.24 in back taxes and \$14,473.06 in interest charges. Council authorized the clerk to commence registering land for sale where owners have not paid their taxes.

"The township is not a bank," said Deputy-Reeve Brenda Hurrele.

The municipality can register improved property where there has been no payment of property tax for three years. Improved property includes such things as buildings on the property and vacant farm land.

In the case of unimproved property, the township can register the land after two years of tax arrears.

Health unit water test results received

The district health unit's water test of some of the catch basins within the village were within acceptable limits. Council was concerned as these results did not match those of an earlier water test conducted by Harmer Podolak Engineering Consultants Inc.

"Since the two tests are so different, we should check again," Hurrele said.

"Makes you wonder who's right," noted Councillor Bob Graham.

Council agreed to ask the health unit to retest the water quality, at no cost to the township, during the early spring before the spring run-off starts.

Commercial exception zoning approved

"I think it would be a mistake to deny this application. The applicants have integrity: what they say they will do is what they will provide — a tea room and an antique shop. Local artists will have a place to sell their wares, and this business will provide employment opportunities to young and old alike. I see that only good will come out of approving this application."

These were the words of a local resident when Reeve Harry Barr opened the discussion of the Clarke/Lewis zoning bylaw amendment to the attending public. The property is located on the west side of County Road 17, within the hamlet of Pakenham.

On Dec. 17, council considered a commercial exception zoning with specified uses. This limited use zoning was the outcome of a Dec. 3 public meeting. The property will be used for a gift shop/gallery, tea room/cafe, and an office.

Barr said council had received one letter from 11 local residents who remain opposed to the zoning change. "I tried to contact their spokesman to address their

concerns, but was unsuccessful," said Percy Lewis, one of the applicants. Five letters of support for the applicants were provided to council.

After public input and thought, council approved the zoning bylaw amendment.

Request to include Pakenham lot in new municipal entity

Council will approach the municipal councils of McNab, Bracside and Arnprior about including the portion of Pakenham known as Lot 27, Concession 12 in their municipal boundary.

The property in question can only be accessed by driving through those municipalities, complicating the provision of township services such as road maintenance and fire protection.

The access problem was created when the Madawaska River was flooded for the Arnprior hydro dam.

Council supports Darling Township

Council will send a letter to Almonte and Ramsay Township asking them to reconsider their decision to exclude Darling Township from the joint amalgamation study.

Appointment of township representative

Ron Blair will represent Pakenham Township on the Mississippi Valley Conservation Authority during 1997.

Environmental resolution supported

The council supported the Mississippi Valley Field Naturalists' resolution that urges the Province of Ontario to thoroughly discuss and evaluate proposed changes in environment protection regulations; report results if proposed changes are put in place; abstain from reducing the environmental regulatory requirements and to monitor and police current environmental laws. The clerk will write a letter of support addressed to MPP Norm Sterling, Ontario's Minister of Environment and Energy.

Cardboard recycling research findings

At the Dec. 3 council meeting, council asked the clerk to find out how the town of Arnprior manages cardboard recycling for its business community.

On Dec. 17, Diane Smithson reported that Arnprior has an agreement with Beaumen Waste Management. The contractor provides small cardboard collection bins to businesses located in the downtown core.

The company is not interested in providing the same service to Pakenham. Council asked the clerk to contact Miller Paving.

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